

Backlog 17 20 Market Cost Tax

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Backlog 17-20: competitors, resale economics, costs and tax

Researched: 2 October 2026

Scope: online-research backlog items 17-20 only.

Method: current official/platform sources were preferred; local-business evidence was cross-checked where possible. Prices are current observations, not quotes. Anything requiring an insurer, seller account, login-only marketplace analytics or professional tax advice remains marked accordingly.

17. Dubbo competitor map

Executive finding

Dubbo does not have an empty e-waste/refurbishment market.

The current local ecosystem already includes:

- retailers and repairers selling refurbished/second-hand devices;
- phone/electronics repairers;
- pawnbrokers buying/selling used electronics;
- Officeworks trade-in and free tech recycling;
- Council e-waste disposal;
- scrap/e-waste recyclers;
- general IT/MSP businesses.

The gap for Dubbo E-Waste is therefore not simply "we take old electronics".

The strongest differentiated proposition remains:

reuse-first collection + documented chain of custody/data handling + refurbishment + asset reporting + resale/redeployment + transparent downstream recycling.

That combined service is much less visible in Dubbo's public market.

Verified local competitors / substitutes

Tech Savvy Dubbo

Current first-party site:

- Shop 101/56 Windsor Parade, Orana Mall, Dubbo.
- Phone/mobile/computer repair.
- Sells second-hand and refurbished devices.
- Advertises a 12-month warranty on its second-hand/refurbished devices.

Source:

- <https://www.techsavvyau.com/>

Competitive overlap: refurbished phones/computers, repair, retail.

Dubbo E-Waste difference to test: supply-side collection, business fleet retirement, chain of custody, data-erasure records, reuse/recycling reporting.

Orana Business Solutions

Current first-party page says it sells refurbished devices and describes a process of:

- inspecting;
- repairing;
- upgrading software/hardware;
- reselling devices.

Address shown: 122-124 Fitzroy Street, Dubbo.

Source:

- <https://obsolutions.com.au/refurbished-devices>

Competitive overlap: business-focused refurbished devices.

Leading Edge Computers Dubbo

Dubbo Chamber currently describes Leading Edge Computers Dubbo as offering:

- computer repairs;
- computer sales/software;
- IT services;
- refurbished and new computers;
- regional NSW service history exceeding 28 years.

Source:

- <https://dubbochamber.com.au/chamber-members/leading-edge-computers-dubbo>
- <https://lecit.com.au/>

The Chamber page says refurbished systems are backed by warranties, but no reliable public duration was established in this pass.

Phone/electronics repair competition

Current local-search results identify:

- SOS Phone Repairs Dubbo, 126 Darling Street;
- Page Electronics, 2/14 Asset Way, television repair;
- David Walters Electronic Services, Burroway/Dubbo area;
- Custom Computer Creations, 10/36 Darling Street;
- Computer Research & Technology, 128 Darling Street.

These businesses overlap with repair work, but public evidence did not establish that they all operate e-waste intake/reuse programs.

Pawnbroker / second-hand electronics channel

Country Cash & Trade, 242 Macquarie Street, says it buys/sells/loans against:

- mobile phones;
- iPads;
- gaming consoles;
- TVs;
- tools and other goods.

Source:

- <https://countrycash.com.au/>

ABN Lookup shows Country Cash & Trade and Ezy Cash Pawnbrokers Dubbo are business names of MEGA STAR VIDEO PTY. LIMITED, ABN 15 056 731 812.

Source:

- <https://abr.business.gov.au/ABN/View?abn=15056731812>

Competitive overlap: supply acquisition and local second-hand resale.

Officeworks Dubbo

Officeworks Dubbo is at 10 Erskine Street.

Current Officeworks recycling policy says:

- tech trade-in covers phones, laptops, tablets, smartwatches, AirPods, Apple Pencil, Apple TV, Fitbits, GoPro and gaming consoles;
- eligible units can produce an Officeworks gift card;
- non-eligible tech can be sent to recycling;
- Bring It Back accepts computers/laptops, phones/smartwatches, chargers/cables, headphones/speakers, gaming consoles/controllers, keyboards/mice, modems/routers/Wi-Fi gear and other specified streams;
- battery collection ceased in Officeworks stores in February 2024;
- users are told to erase personal information before handover.

Sources:

- <https://www.officeworks.com.au/information/about-us/recycling>

- <https://www.officeworks.com.au/shop/officeworks/storepage/W218/NSW/LINK>

Competitive overlap: free disposal and trade-in, especially households.

Important distinction: Officeworks is a strong reason not to market Dubbo E-Waste merely as a convenient household recycling point.

Clarification — Officeworks is a collection/trade-in channel, not the Dubbo processor

Officeworks is relevant to the Dubbo competitor/substitute map because it gives residents another way to hand over unwanted technology.

It should not be described as an industrial e-waste recycler operating in the Dubbo store.

The accurate distinction is:

- Tech Trade-in: eligible devices may be traded for Officeworks value/gift-card value and can enter a reuse/resale pathway.
- Bring it Back / recycling: selected unwanted technology can be handed in and then sent onward through Officeworks' recycling partners.
- Dubbo store: this is the local consumer handover point, not the specialist dismantling/shredding plant.
- National vs local acceptance: do not assume every nationally advertised category is accepted at the Dubbo store without checking the store/program conditions.
- Officeworks stopped in-store battery collection in February 2024.

Correct repo wording:

Officeworks is an existing retail trade-in / technology collection channel and disposal substitute for some Dubbo households. It is not being described as the local downstream recycler.

This matters strategically because Dubbo eWaste should not compete on "somewhere to get rid of an old laptop". It should compete on reuse triage, documented data handling, refurbishment, asset reporting, local resale/redeployment and transparent final outcomes.

Dubbo Regional Council

Council's A-Z recycling guide directs computers/e-waste to Council recycling/waste depots and Officeworks.

Source:

- <https://www.dubbo.nsw.gov.au/Households-Residents/Rubbish-Recycling-and-Sustainability/Domestic-Waste-Services/a-z-recycling>

Council is a free/low-cost disposal substitute for residents, not primarily a refurb/resale competitor.

Scrap/e-waste recyclers

Current local-search evidence includes:

- Australian Metal Recycling / former Matthews yard, 34 Mountbatten Drive;
- Orana Wool Scrap Metal, 21L Newell Highway, which public directory material associates with scrap/electronic waste;

- Council's Whylandra facility.

The AMR chain is covered in the repository's separate AMR research.

MSP/IT-provider context

Dubbo also has multiple business IT providers. They matter because they may:

- manage refresh cycles;
- already arrange disposal;
- become competitors for ITAD work;
- or become upstream referral/supply partners.

Current local-search examples include Gravity IT Solutions, Avance Business Technology, Gorilla IT, Leading Edge Computers, Inland Technology and other IT service firms.

No claim is made here about their private asset-disposal arrangements.

Competitor positioning conclusion

Do not position Dubbo E-Waste as:

"Dubbo finally has somewhere to take old electronics."

That is demonstrably false.

A stronger positioning hypothesis is:

"We try to keep usable technology in use first. For businesses we can inventory assets, document data sanitisation, refurbish/redeploy viable equipment and provide an auditable route for the remainder."

That still needs market validation.

18. Resale economics

eBay Australia — major correction

The repository's old working assumption of roughly 13% eBay fees is wrong for the intended small pilot if the account qualifies for eBay's current Australian free-selling model.

eBay's current Australian policy says an Australia-based seller:

- with AU\$25,000 or less in eBay sales over the prior 12 months;
- who is not on an eBay Pro plan;

can sell on eBay.com.au with no transaction/final-value fee.

Other costs can still apply, including:

- optional listing upgrades;
- overseas delivery/international fees;
- postage labels;
- refunds;
- promoted listings if used;
- additional fees for poor seller performance in applicable circumstances.

Source:

- <https://www.ebay.com.au/help/selling/fees-credits-invoices/selling-fees-managed-payments-sellers?id=4822>

Above the threshold / Pro plans

Current monthly Pro subscriptions, GST-inclusive:

- Pro Starter: \$0/month
- Pro Basic: \$27.45/month
- Pro Featured: \$82.45/month
- Pro Anchor: \$604.95/month

Pro sellers and sellers above AU\$25,000 rolling-12-month eBay sales pay category-dependent transaction fees.

Source:

- <https://www.ebay.com.au/help/selling/fees-credits-invoices/ebay-pro-selling-fees?id=4809>

Implication for pilot modelling

For a tiny pilot, do not deduct 13% automatically.

Track the actual account state:

- rolling 12-month eBay sales;
- Pro plan status;
- optional promotion/listing fees;
- label/postage cost;
- refunds/returns.

When the project approaches AU\$25,000 rolling eBay sales, rebuild the margin model from the then-current Pro fee table.

Facebook Marketplace

Meta's current Australian help pages say Marketplace selling with platform delivery/shipping is not available in this location, and direct users to local selling.

Sources:

- <https://www.facebook.com/help/796066857221106>
- <https://www.facebook.com/help/3559483297614032>

No reliable current Australian official page was found establishing a mandatory Facebook transaction fee for ordinary local Marketplace sales.

Treat Marketplace as a local lead/sale channel, with payment/pickup risk handled separately.

Gumtree — current-source conflict

Gumtree's live help centre is internally inconsistent.

One current help result says:

- Gumtree Pay is free for sellers;
- buyer pays the platform fee;
- seller receives the agreed amount including charged shipping.

Source:

- https://help.gumtree.com.au/AU/articles/en_US/KB_Article/Payments-FAQ/

A different live Gumtree guide/cache still says a 0.5% seller platform fee, capped at \$7.50.

Because official Gumtree pages conflict as of this research date:

Do not hard-code a Gumtree fee into the business model. Re-check the checkout/account fee disclosure immediately before first use.

Ordinary electronics are not identified among the small set of mandatory paid-listing categories.

Source:

- https://help.gumtree.com.au/AU/articles/en_US/KB_Article/Which-categories-have-a-listing-fee-AU/

Gumtree introduced protected shipping through Gumtree Pay in 2026, subject to its policy/eligibility requirements.

Source:

- https://help.gumtree.com.au/AU/articles/en_US/KB_Article/Gumtree-Pay-with-Protected-Shipping-Policy-for-Sellers/

Sold-price research

Public sold-listing searches are useful for individual model pricing, but they are not a defensible substitute for a proper average:

- configurations differ;
- condition differs;
- freight may be included/excluded;
- parts-only units distort results;
- public search samples can be incomplete;
- eBay Product Research/Terapeak-style analytics are account/tool dependent.

Phase 0 pricing rule

For each accepted device, price using same-model or genuinely comparable sold listings, not asking prices.

Record:

- CPU/RAM/storage;
- battery condition;
- grade/defects;
- charger;
- warranty/returns promise;
- postage;
- date of sale.

The pilot tracker has been expanded in backlog item 31 so these economics can be measured rather than guessed.

Platform return economics

Even when a seller selects "no returns", eBay buyer-protection/consumer-law circumstances can still generate returns for damaged, faulty or not-as-described goods.

Therefore every margin calculation should reserve for:

- outbound postage;
- return postage where seller-labile;
- packaging;
- occasional refund/write-off.

Source:

- <https://www.ebay.com.au/help/buying/returns-refunds/return-item-refund?id=4041>

19. Repo cost assumptions — verification pass

Confirmed / corrected

Business name

For 2026–27:

- \$47 / 1 year
- \$108 / 3 years

Australian Government source:

- <https://business.gov.au/news/changes-for-businesses-from-1-july-2026>
- <https://business.gov.au/registrations/register-your-business-name>

Company setup comparison

For 2026-27:

- proprietary company registration: \$636
- proprietary company annual review: \$342

Source:

- <https://business.gov.au/news/changes-for-businesses-from-1-july-2026>
- <https://business.gov.au/registrations/work-out-your-business-registrations/categories>

A company is therefore materially more expensive than a sole-trader pilot before accounting/legal costs.

GST threshold

ATO current guidance: registration is compulsory when GST turnover is \$75,000 or more, including where a new business expects to reach it.

Source:

- <https://www.ato.gov.au/businesses-and-organisations/gst-excise-and-indirect-taxes/gst/registering-for-gst>

Electricity benchmark for a future workshop

For the Essential Energy NSW distribution zone, the AER 2026-27 small-business Default Market Offer comparison price at benchmark consumption of 10,000 kWh/year is:

- flat: \$5,517/year
- time of use/non-regulated tariff benchmark: \$4,919/year

This is a comparison price, not a predicted Dubbo E-Waste bill.

Source:

- <https://www.aer.gov.au/industry/retail/default-market-offer>

Insurance

The repo's \$800-\$1,500/year estimate is not sufficiently evidenced.

Online research can identify policy types, but a useful price requires disclosure of:

- residential home-based operation;
- customers visiting;
- product sales;
- repairs;
- lithium-battery-bearing electronics;
- stock value;
- data-bearing devices;
- tools/equipment;
- fire risk.

Therefore replace the numeric estimate with:

Insurance: quote required; public + product liability are core, and stock/equipment/cyber cover should be considered depending on activities.

Do not budget from generic comparison-site averages.

Warehouse rents

Online commercial listings can establish only asking-rent benchmarks, not a future budget.

Current 2026 Dubbo search results observed small industrial/workshop spaces around the low-hundreds-of-dollars per week plus GST/outgoings, with larger sheds substantially higher.

Because listings change rapidly, the repo should not use a single warehouse number until a move is actually being considered. Record at least three live comparable E4/industrial properties at that time.

Costs that remain quote/live-market dependent

- insurer premium;
- shelving/racking suited to final premises;
- electrical safety/PAT equipment if adopted;
- fire equipment after risk assessment;
- SSD/RAM/chargers/batteries/screens;
- packaging;
- courier rates;
- commercial downstream disposal;
- suitable industrial rent and outgoings.

The pilot should measure these as actuals.

20. Tax, accounting and structure

Sole trader versus company

Australian Government guidance currently shows:

Sole trader

- ABN: free;
- business-name fee if using a name other than personal name: \$47/1 yr or \$108/3 yrs;
- individual remains legally responsible for the business.

Company

- separate legal entity;

- proprietary company registration: \$636;
- annual review: \$342;
- business-name fee may also apply.

Source:

- <https://business.gov.au/planning/business-structures-and-types/business-structures/difference-between-a-sole-trader-and-a-company>
- <https://business.gov.au/registrations/work-out-your-business-registrations/categories>

This does not by itself decide the right structure. Waste/product/data liability may justify professional advice before scaling.

GST

GST registration becomes compulsory at \$75,000 GST turnover.

Source:

- <https://www.ato.gov.au/businesses-and-organisations/gst-excise-and-indirect-taxes/gst/registering-for-gst>

Below the threshold it can generally be voluntary, but voluntary registration creates GST/BAS obligations.

Second-hand goods and GST — important future issue

Division 66 can provide special GST treatment where a GST-registered business acquires qualifying second-hand goods from a supplier whose sale was not taxable and acquires them for sale/exchange in the ordinary course of business.

ATO material explains that this can allow an input tax credit even though the unregistered supplier did not charge GST.

Records for relevant second-hand acquisitions include:

- supplier name/address;
- description and quantity;
- acquisition date;
- consideration paid.

Sources:

- <https://www.ato.gov.au/law/view/document?docid=%22GSD%2FGSTD20132%2FNAT%2FATO%2F00001%22>
- <https://www.ato.gov.au/law/view/pdf?DocId=ESO%2FESLI2025D11%2F00001&PiT=99991231235958&filename=law%2Fview%2Fpdf%2Fesg%2Fesli2025-d011.pdf>
- <https://www.ato.gov.au/law/view/document?docid=AID%2FAID20039%2F00001>

Free donations

Do not assume a GST credit exists merely because a donated device later gets resold.

Where acquisition consideration is \$0, there is no purchase consideration from which to derive the normal Division 66 second-hand acquisition credit.

Get accounting advice before applying Division 66 to mixed free/donation/buyback/part-out streams.

Parting out second-hand goods

ATO interpretative material specifically contemplates a second-hand dealer acquiring a lot, dividing it and reconditioning/selling parts, provided the Division 66 conditions and records are satisfied.

Source:

- <https://www.ato.gov.au/law/view/document?docid=AID%2FAID20039%2F00001>

This is relevant if Dubbo E-Waste becomes GST registered and routinely parts purchased second-hand assets.

Home-based business deductions

ATO guidance distinguishes:

- running expenses, such as additional energy, internet, depreciation/repairs of business equipment;
- occupancy expenses, which depend on whether an area has the character of a place of business and can have other tax implications.

Sources:

- <https://www.ato.gov.au/individuals-and-families/income-deductions-offsets-and-records/deductions-you-can-claim/working-from-home-expenses>
- <https://www.ato.gov.au/api/public/content/0-8551e46a-7b10-44c9-b5b4-7fc8bd0c32d5>

Because the current property is rented, the homeowner-CGT consequence is not Josh's current issue, but occupancy/rent apportionment should still be accountant-led if claimed.

Record retention

ATO's general rule is 5 years for most business/tax records, with some circumstances requiring longer.

Sources:

- <https://www.ato.gov.au/law/view/document?LocID=%22TXR%2FTR967%2FNAT%2FATO%22>
- <https://www.ato.gov.au/api/public/content/0-53cc7a8e-0668-4c9d-95d7-eb841eb09c04>

Instant asset write-off

ATO's current 2026-27 small-business guidance says the instant asset write-off threshold is \$20,000 per eligible asset for eligible small businesses using simplified depreciation, with aggregated turnover below \$10 million. Both new and second-hand eligible assets can qualify.

Source:

- <https://community.ato.gov.au/s/article/a07Mo00002BaUj6lAN/can-my-small-business-claim-the-20000-instant-asset-writeoff>

Check the main ATO legislative guidance again before making a material purchase.

Business-name / trademark / domain availability

Public search results are not sufficient to declare "Dubbo E-Waste" available.

Before registration:

1. run ASIC's current business-name availability check;
2. search IP Australia's Trade Mark Search/TM Checker for confusingly similar marks;
3. check the desired .com.au/.au domain with an accredited registrar;
4. check social handles.

Business-name registration does not create exclusive brand rights.

Source:

- <https://business.gov.au/registrations/register-your-business-name>

Decisions / corrections from 17-20

1. Remove the old blanket ~13% eBay fee assumption.
2. Model eBay at actual account status; eligible sub-\$25k/non-Pro sellers currently pay no final-value fee.
3. Treat Gumtree fees as unresolved because Gumtree's own live pages conflict.
4. Keep Facebook Marketplace local-first; platform shipping is currently unavailable in Australia.
5. Replace generic insurance-dollar estimate with quote required.
6. Keep verified business-name costs at \$47/\$108.
7. Keep GST threshold at \$75,000, now sourced directly to ATO.
8. If later GST registered, get accountant advice on Division 66 before buying/reselling/parting out second-hand lots.
9. The competitive proposition should be reuse + data/asset accountability, not merely waste acceptance.

Sources

Local competition

- Tech Savvy Dubbo: <https://www.techsavvyau.com/>
- Orana Business Solutions refurbished devices: <https://obsolutions.com.au/refurbished-devices>
- Leading Edge Computers Dubbo / Chamber: <https://dubbochamber.com.au/chamber-members/leading-edge-computers-dubbo>
- Country Cash & Trade: <https://countrycash.com.au/>
- Country Cash/Ezy Cash entity: <https://abr.business.gov.au/ABN/View?abn=15056731812>
- Officeworks recycling: <https://www.officeworks.com.au/information/about-us/recycling>
- Officeworks Dubbo: <https://www.officeworks.com.au/shop/officeworks/storepage/W218/NSW/LINK>
- DRC A-Z recycling: <https://www.dubbo.nsw.gov.au/Households-Residents/Rubbish-Recycling-and-Sustainability/Domestic-Waste-Services/a-z-recycling>

Selling

- eBay non-Pro fees: <https://www.ebay.com.au/help/selling/fees-credits-invoices/selling-fees-managed-payment-s-sellers?id=4822>
- eBay Pro fees: <https://www.ebay.com.au/help/selling/fees-credits-invoices/ebay-pro-selling-fees?id=4809>
- Gumtree fees/help: https://help.gumtree.com.au/AU/articles/en_US/KB_Article/Payments-FAQ/
- Facebook Marketplace delivery limitation: <https://www.facebook.com/help/796066857221106>

Business/tax

- Business changes 1 July 2026: <https://business.gov.au/news/changes-for-businesses-from-1-july-2026>
- Business-name registration: <https://business.gov.au/registrations/register-your-business-name>
- Structure comparison: <https://business.gov.au/planning/business-structures-and-types/business-structures/difference-between-a-sole-trader-and-a-company>
- GST registration: <https://www.ato.gov.au/businesses-and-organisations/gst-excise-and-indirect-taxes/gst/registering-for-gst>
- Second-hand GST: <https://www.ato.gov.au/law/view/document?docid=%22GSD%2FGSTD20132%2FNAT%2FATO%2F00001%22>
- Home-business expenses: <https://www.ato.gov.au/individuals-and-families/income-deductions-offsets-and-records/deductions-you-can-claim/working-from-home-expenses>
- AER DMO: <https://www.aer.gov.au/industry/retail/default-market-offer>

Supplementary live-market findings — 2 October 2026

Current Dubbo industrial/workshop asking rents

Live commercial-property searches provide a better scale-up benchmark than the repo's earlier broad startup estimate.

Examples surfaced in the current market include:

- 13 McGuinn Crescent: about 200 m² from \$395/week + GST;
- 6 Depot Road: about 236 m² at \$442.30/week + GST;
- another current 373 m² industrial listing around \$45,000/year + GST/outgoings;
- a larger 573 m² option around \$1,000/week, with the listing indicating outgoings included;
- a recent 222 m² Asset Way lease recorded around \$650/week + GST;
- 476 m² Depot Road around \$895/week + GST + rates/insurance.

These are asking/recent listing figures, not achieved-rent forecasts. They demonstrate why Phase 0 should not take premises before supply and margins are proven.

Re-check live listings immediately before any future lease decision.

Current listing/search references:

- <https://www.realcommercial.com.au/for-lease/dubbo-nsw-2830/industrial-warehouse/>
- <https://www.commercialrealestate.com.au/for-lease/dubbo-nsw-2830/industrial-warehouse/>

Scrap/e-waste commodity value

Australian Metal Recycling's current public model distinguishes between materials it buys and streams it accepts as free recycling.

Its current public material says it pays for commodity metals such as copper, aluminium, brass, lead, stainless steel and other recoverable scrap, while e-waste is promoted primarily as a free recycling stream.

A current Dubbo AMR social/local listing published late August 2026 advertised indicative copper/brass rates such as roughly:

- bright & shiny copper: \$14/kg;
- bright copper: \$13/kg;
- burnt copper: \$12/kg;
- clean brass: \$8/kg.

Those numbers are secondary, date-specific commodity quotes, not guaranteed e-waste payouts.

Margin rule

Do not assign a generic per-kilogram scrap value to incoming computers.

Instead record the real outcome:

- recycler charges \$X;
- recycler takes it free;
- recycler pays \$X for a separated commodity fraction.

The project's economics should remain driven by reuse/refurbishment, not speculative commodity prices.

Primary operator source:

- <https://australianmetalrecycling.com.au/>

Remaining price research that is inherently live

The following cannot be usefully "solved once" online:

- SSD/RAM/screen/battery replacement prices;
- courier cost for a particular packed device;
- sold-market price for a particular refurb configuration;
- current commodity payout;
- future warehouse rent.

The correct implementation is already in the expanded pilot tracker: record the actual direct price/cost on each job rather than maintaining a static average.